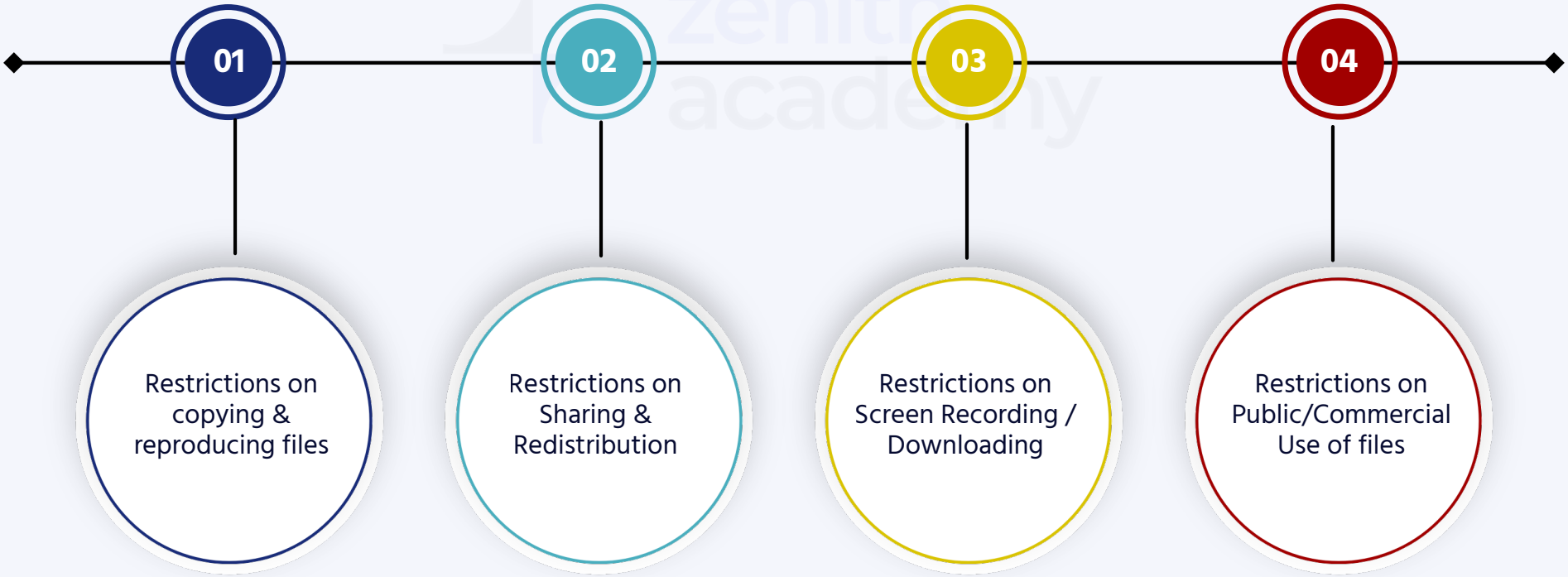
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Social institutions

Social Institutions are the organized system that make society function

They are not buildings or offices but sets of rules, roles and relationships that help people live together peacefully.

These institutions structure our lives by guiding how we behave, interact and meet basic needs.

Every Community no matter how large or Small, depends on them to maintain order and stability.

From birth to death we are shaped bySocial institutions

They influence what we learn, how we work, how we form families and even what we believe.

Without them life would be chaotic because people would not know how to behave or What roles to play in Society

A social institution is an interrelated system of social roles and social norms,
organized around the satisfaction of an important social need or social function.
Social Institutions are organized patterns of beliefs and behaviour that are centered on basic
social needs

Characteristics of social institution

Social institutions are universal.

They vary from time to time and across cultures, in terms of complexity, specialization, scope, formality and organization. But their basic nature and purpose are similar everywhere.

Social institutions are resistant to change; they tend to persist.

Each institution performs two types of social function.

(a) primary functions, which are also called manifest, explicit, or direct functions;

(b) secondary functions, which are also called indirect, hidden, or latent functions. Through these functions, social institutions fulfill important needs in the society

Various social institutions are

1. Marriage
2. Family
3. Education
4. Economy
5. Religion
6. Political institution

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Definition of Family

A family is a basic social institution consisting of individuals related by blood, marriage or adoption, who usually live together and share responsibilities, resources and social relationships. Families can be classified on the basis of structure, authority, residence, marriage system and relationship.

Types of Family Based on Structure

1. Nuclear Family

A nuclear family consists of a husband, wife and their unmarried children living together as a single family unit.

Example: Parents and their two children living separately from grandparents.

2. Joint Family

A joint family consists of two or more generations living together, sharing a common household, resources and responsibilities. It often includes grandparents, parents, children and other relatives

3. Extended Family

An extended family includes members beyond the nuclear family, such as grandparents, uncles, aunts, cousins and other relatives. They may live together or maintain close family relationships while living separately.

Types of Family Based onAuthority

4. Patriarchal Family

A patriarchal family is a family in which the father or the senior male member holds the primary authority and decision-making power.

5. Matriarchal Family

A matriarchal family is a family in which the mother or a senior female member holds the primary authority and decision-making power.

Types of Family Based on Residence

6. Patrilocal Family

A patrilocal family is one in which the married couple lives with or near the husband's parents or family.

7. Matrilocal Family

A matrilocal family is one in which the married couple lives with or near the wife's parents or family.

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Types of Family Based on Marriage

8. Monogamous Family

A monogamous family is based on a marriage system in which a person has only one spouse at a time.

9. Polygamous Family

A polygamous family is based on a marriage system in which a person has more than one spouse at the same time.

Polygamy is broadly classified into two types:

Polygyny: One man has more than one wife at the same time.

Polyandry: One woman has more than one husband at the same time.

Types of Family Based on Marriage Rules

11. Endogamous Family

An endogamous family is formed through a marriage that takes place within a particular social group, caste, tribe or community, as prescribed by its marriage rules.

12. Exogamous Family

An exogamous family is formed through a marriage that takes place outside a prescribed social group, clan or lineage, according to its marriage rules.

Types of Family Based on Relationships

13. Conjugal Family

A conjugal family is based primarily on the marital relationship between husband and wife and their dependent children, if any. The emphasis is on relationships established through marriage.

14. Consanguineous Family

A consanguineous family is based primarily on relationships by blood, such as those between parents and children, siblings and other blood relatives.

Nuclear family – Husband, wife and unmarried children.

Joint family – Multiple generations living together and sharing resources.

Patriarchal family – Male authority.

Matriarchal family – Female authority.

Patrilocal family – Residence near the husband's family.

Matrilocal family – Residence near the wife's family.

Monogamy – One spouse at a time.

Polygamy – More than one spouse at the same time.

Polyandry – One woman with multiple husbands.

Polygyny – One man with multiple wives.

Endogamy – Marriage within a prescribed group.

Exogamy – Marriage outside a prescribed group.

Conjugal family – Marital relationship.

Consanguineous family – Blood relationship.

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1. Which of the following best describes a social institution?
A) A group of people gathered temporarily for a common purpose
B) An organized system of social norms and relationships designed to fulfil basic societal needs
C) A collection of individuals sharing similar personal interests
D) A temporary association formed to achieve a specific objective

ANS:B Social institutions are established systems of norms and practices that fulfil basic social needs.

2. Which of the following is considered the primary agent of socialization?
A) Mass media
B) Educational institutions
C) Family
D) Political institutions

ANS.:C Family is generally the primary agent of socialization, especially during childhood.

3. Which of the following statements correctly distinguishes a social institution from a social organization?
A) A social institution refers only to formal groups, whereas an organization refers to informal norms.
B) A social institution is a system of established norms and practices, whereas a social organization is a structured group of individuals.
C) Social institutions exist only in traditional societies, whereas organizations exist only in modern societies.
D) Social institutions and social organizations are identical in their functions and structure.

ANS:B Institutions consist of established norms and practices; organizations are structured groups of people.

4. The family is regarded as a primary social institution mainly because it:
A) Regulates all economic activities in society
B) Performs the exclusive function of political administration
C) Provides primary socialization, emotional support, and care for children
D) Eliminates social inequality in all societies

ANS:C Family provides primary socialization,
emotional support, and care for children

5. A family in which authority is primarily vested in the father is known as

A. Matriarchal family
B .Patriarchal family

C.Egalitarian family
D .Matrilocal family
Ans. B

6. Which of the following is an example of a known essential or secondary function of the family in traditional sociology?
A. Reproduction
B. Socialization
C. Emotional support
D providing recreation
Ans .D
7. Which of the following is a major economic function traditionally performed by the family?
A. Production and consumption of goods and services
B. Conducting judicial proceedings
C. Enforcing criminal laws
D. Managing public elections
Ans.A
7. A family in which descent and inheritance are traced through the mother's line is described as
A Patrilineal
B.Matrilineal
C Matrilocal
D.Neolocal
Ans.B Matrilineal

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